

GO · VARIANT 1 OF 13

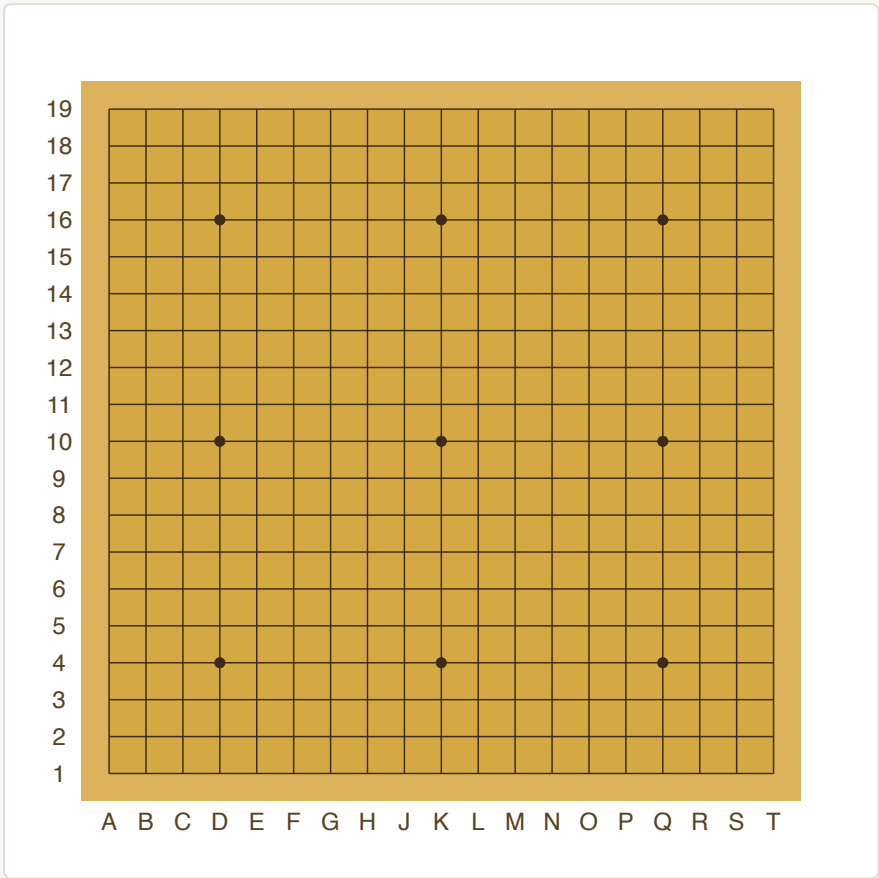
# Standard Go (19×19)

**19×19**  
BOARD

**2**  
PLAYERS

# STANDARD GO (19×19)

The full tournament game played on a 19×19 grid with 361 intersections. One fundamental rule — capture by surrounding — produces extraordinary strategic depth. Games last 60–180 minutes at tournament level.



Go — 19×19 board

## COMPONENTS

| ITEM         | QTY | NOTES                                             |
|--------------|-----|---------------------------------------------------|
| Board        | 1   | 19×19 grid (361 intersections)                    |
| Black stones | 181 | Enough to cover slightly more than half the board |
| White stones | 180 | One fewer than Black (Black plays first)          |

## SETUP

The board starts empty. Black plays first. Stones are placed on intersections (where lines cross), not inside squares.

## RULES

**Placement:** On each turn, a player places one stone of their colour on any empty intersection, or passes.

**Liberties and capture:**

- ♦ An empty intersection adjacent to a stone (horizontally or vertically) is a liberty.
- ♦ Adjacent same-colour stones form a group and share liberties.
- ♦ A group with zero liberties is captured and removed from the board.
- ♦ A stone may be placed on a zero-liberty intersection if doing so captures opponent stones.

**Ko rule:** A move that returns the board to the immediately previous position is forbidden. If one player captures a single stone, the opponent must play elsewhere before recapturing.

**Suicide:** A move that would leave your own group with zero liberties without capturing any opponent stones is forbidden.

## SCORING

The game ends when both players pass consecutively.

**Area scoring (Chinese):** Score = your stones on the board + empty intersections surrounded only by your stones.

**Territory scoring (Japanese):** Score = empty intersections you surround – your captured stones (prisoners).

Both methods produce the same winner in nearly all cases.

## KOMI

White receives 6.5 points of compensation for moving second. The half-point prevents draws.

## ATTRIBUTION

Traditional game originating in China approximately 4,000 years ago. Known as Weiqi (Chinese), Baduk (Korean), Igo (Japanese). Public domain. Rules standardised by the International Go Federation.